Project Report:

DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

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Introduction

As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador at Vellore Institute of Technology Bhopal, my primary responsibility is to help my peers safely and confidently navigate the modern digital landscape. The digital world can be overwhelming for first-year college students who are transitioning from highly guided school environments to independent online learning and professional networking.

This project serves as my foundational Digital Literacy Portfolio, which I will present to the faculty committee and share with my batchmates as a practical guide. Through five highly detailed tasks, this report documents the hands-on creation of visual awareness materials, the establishment of a professional digital footprint across developer platforms, and the practical use of collaborative and coding environments. Furthermore, it addresses the critical nuances of online communication etiquette and provides a comprehensive guide to recognizing and preventing modern cybercrimes. Ultimately, this portfolio acts as both a personal milestone in my digital journey and a comprehensive toolkit to help my peers become secure, responsible digital citizens.

Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For the first task, I created a one-page visual resource breaking down what digital literacy means and why it is crucial for our batch. I chose Canva to design this infographic due to its intuitive interface, excellent typography, and extensive library of free, high-quality vector graphics and 3D illustrations.

I structured the infographic into clearly defined, visually distinct panels to make the information easy to digest. The header defines digital literacy as the ability to safely use, understand, evaluate, and create digital content, framing it as a student superpower. Below this, I organized the core information into three main blocks, at first Useful Digital Tools: Highlighting essential productivity platforms like Google Workspace, Canva, and cloud storage. Second, Safe Internet Practices: Outlining critical security habits, including strong passwords, avoiding phishing, and managing privacy settings. Professional Online Presence: Emphasizing the creation of a LinkedIn profile and sharing portfolios to build a positive digital footprint. Finally, the bottom panel serves as a quick, icon-driven guide to email etiquette, reminding students to use clear subject lines, check grammar, and use professional closings.

The most interesting part of this process was learning to communicate complex ideas using minimal text. Leveraging my background in video and poster editing, I focused heavily on visual hierarchy using bolder fonts, neon borders, and colourful icons to guide the reader's eye. My biggest challenge was resisting the urge to over-explain; I constantly refined my sentences into short bullet points to keep the infographic an accessible quick-reference guide. The final image is in the task-1-presentation/ folder.

Task 2 Write-up: Building a Student Digital Portfolio

In today's highly competitive tech industry, a professional digital presence is absolutely mandatory; it is often the first thing internship coordinators and potential employers look at. For this task, I established my foundational online presence across three key platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, Stack Overflow and ResearchGate.

Platform Selection and Purpose: GitHub, as a Computer Science student specializing in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, GitHub is my most critical platform. It is where I will host the source code for all my Python projects, track versions of my software, and

collaborate on hackathons. I created a profile README that introduces my name, my B. Tech branch, and my current focus on mastering neural networks and deep learning.

LinkedIn, I set up my LinkedIn profile purely for professional networking. I updated the Education section with my current degree, institution name, and my expected graduation year. This platform will be essential for connecting with industry professionals, university alumni, and recruiters.

Kaggle, I created a Kaggle account because it is the premier platform for data science and machine learning. It provides access to massive datasets and community-driven coding notebooks, which are vital for training the AI models I am currently studying.

Over the next four years, I plan to treat GitHub as my living, breathing resume, constantly pushing new project code to it. I will use Kaggle to participate in beginner data science competitions to sharpen my predictive modelling skills, and I will use LinkedIn to document these achievements and share my portfolio website, with a broader audience. Screenshots verifying the setup of all three profiles have been uploaded to the task-2-portfolio/ folder.

Task 3 Write-up: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

To effectively guide my peers, I must first be deeply familiar with the online tools we use for studying, practicing coding, and collaborating on group assignments.

Part A - Coding Practice: I selected HackerRank as my primary coding practice platform. HackerRank is highly regarded in the tech industry for its algorithm challenges, which companies frequently use during technical interview screening. I navigated to their Python preparation module and successfully completed the introductory challenge, which required taking user inputs, performing a basic arithmetic operation, and printing the correct output. This exercise familiarized me with reading standard input/output streams within an integrated browser environment. The screenshot of my successful test case compilation and completion badge is saved in the task-3-platforms/ folder.

Part B - Google Workspace Collaboration: For the collaboration component, I utilized Google Forms to build a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz". This tool is incredibly powerful for seamlessly gathering and organizing data. I designed exactly five questions aimed at testing basic digital safety. The quiz includes multiple-choice and short-answer questions.

These platforms will be foundational to my academic success. HackerRank will allow me to continuously practice the logic and algorithms required for my AI/ML coursework, while Google Forms—integrated directly with Google Sheets—will allow me to easily collect survey data for research papers, organize club activities, and gather feedback from my peers. The link to this form is included in my main README file, and the required screenshots are in the task-3-platforms/ folder.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Communication & Etiquette Guide

Digital communication requires a specific tone and structure to remain professional and respectful. Poor digital communication can severely damage a student's academic and professional reputation.

For example, imagine a scenario where a student urgently needs help with a system error right before a project deadline. They send an email to their professor with no subject line, starting with "Hey, my code isn't working, please fix it," and they forget to include their name or registration number. The professor, who manages hundreds of students, will likely ignore this email because it lacks context, lacks a respectful tone, and provides no identifying information. This communication failure results in the student missing their deadline. This could have easily been avoided by using a clear subject line, a formal greeting, a detailed description of the error, and a polite sign-off.

To demonstrate proper etiquette, I drafted two specific emails, which are saved in the task-4-email-etiquette/ folder.

1. Email 1 (Extension Request): A polite, clearly justified request to a professor asking for a two-day extension on a lab record submission due to an unexpected medical issue, complete with a formal greeting and my registration details.
2. Email 2 (Internship Inquiry): A concise, professional message directed to a company's HR coordinator expressing my deep interest in a summer software engineering internship, briefly highlighting my Python skills and requesting a brief meeting.

I also created a highly detailed Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist, which outlines crucial rules like never posting emotional rants about professors online, avoiding sharing live location data, and always assuming that anything posted on the internet is permanent.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

For my case study, I researched Cyberbullying, a pervasive and devastating form of online harassment targeting students.

Case Study Overview: Cyberbullying uses digital platforms to repeatedly threaten, insult, or humiliate socially vulnerable individuals. Unlike physical bullying, it is relentless, occurring 24/7. It typically begins with hurtful comments and escalates rapidly through edited images, leaked private chats, and fake accounts. The consequences are severe, causing victims to experience deep social isolation, intense anxiety, depression, and a complete loss of academic focus.

Reflection and Habit Changes: What surprised me most was how the perceived anonymity of the internet dramatically reduces human empathy, allowing harassment to scale out of control rapidly. The attackers exploit digital distance, not just technology.

As a result, I am changing a major personal habit: I will no longer be a passive bystander. I will actively report and block fake accounts spreading hate and ensure targeted peers know to report abuse to the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) or the 1930 Helpline.
My prevention checklist is saved in the task-5-cybercrime/ folder.

Conclusion

Completing this Digital Literacy project has provided me with a robust, practical toolkit for succeeding in a digital-first academic environment. Beyond just creating accounts, I have learned the strategic value of maintaining a professional digital footprint on developer platforms, the critical importance of tone and structure in professional emails, and the psychological tactics used in modern cybercrimes. By organizing all these deliverables into a structured GitHub repository, I have also practiced the exact version control and documentation skills required in the software engineering industry. I am now fully equipped to step into my role as a Student Digital Ambassador and share these essential practices with my batchmates.

References

- Canva, Visual design platform. https://www.canva.com
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- Google Forms, Online survey and form creation tool. https://forms.google.com
- HackerRank, Technical skills practice platform. https://www.hackerrank.com
- Kaggle, Data science and machine learning platform. https://kaggle.com
- LinkedIn, Professional networking platform. https://www.linkedin.com
- Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India, National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal. https://cybercrime.gov.in/
- ResearchGate, Professional networking platform for researchers and scientists. https://www.researchgate.net
- Stack Overflow, Question and answer platform for programmers. https://stackoverflow.com